Bluff

SEO

SEM: This stands for Search Engine Marketing. SEM is the marketing of a Web site through search engines, either by improving page ranks or buying listings on search engines.
Pagerank: Also referred to as Google Pagerank, this signifies the importance of a Web page on the World Wide Web, with respect to a search string.
Spiders: These are programs that search engines use to index Web pages. Spiders are also known as crawlers and regularly scan through Web sites to update the search engine's records.
CPC: This refers to cost per click and is the amount that the company being marketed has to pay to the search engine for each of its links clicked.
CTR: CTR is an abbreviation of Click Through Rate. This signifies the success of an online ad campaign. For example, the clicking on a banner or ad is considered a success only if it materialises into further business with the company.
PPC: Pay per click is a very popular term in online marketing. This refers to the service where the company pays for each of its ads that visitors click on.
Black Hat SEO: This is the act of using "unethical" measures to promote one's Web site. This is done at the risk of being blacklisted by the respective search engine.
White Hat SEO: A white hat is one who follows ethical methods to promote his/her site.
Usage: I had started my new venture. I thought the best way would be *SEM*. I designed my site as per Google's *spider* requirements and improved my *Pagerank*. To avoid unnecessary costing, I chose words with lower *PPC* and *CPC* rates, so that with a lower budget I could still manage an economical *CTR*. I have principles and so chose to be a *White Hat*, unlike others who don't mind being *Black Hats*.

Wild Wild Web

Dress Up Games

If you were to head over to **http://www.petsinuniform.com/**, you would have only one question in your head—why would anyone want to do this? This Web site provides a valuable service to doting pet owners who want to see their dogs and cats in full military regalia. Simply chose a uniform and a background, upload a high resolution close up picture of your pet and wait for three business days to get the photos of your pet fitted out in glittering ribbons and peaked caps. For this dressing up, the good folks at Pets in Uniform would charge you $19.99 (almost Rs 800). Pay up for the sake of your cuties.

Seriously, this Web site has convinced us that we are wasting our time writing articles when there is so much easy money to be made off the Internet. Sigh.

Documentation Humour

Normally, technical documentation and signboards are dry and boring. Manuals are the last place for finding comic relief while signboards convey serious hazards with a minimum of fuss. However, sometimes quite unintentionally, these dull instructions have the potential for a laugh or two. Hall of Technical Documentation Weirdness (**http://www.darrenbarefoot.com/hall/main.php**) documents hundreds of sources of comic relief that sometimes make you go crazy!

For example, what would be your reaction when you see a sign inside a toilet forbidding either leaves inside the bowl or swan dives off the seat? Or the bit of honest advice on a warning board for "Wet Floor" which counsels you to recline luxuriously in case you happen to slip?

whole, the picture looks quite gloomy. However, for geeks that are lucky to have found a lady willing to put up with their eccentricities, they face the final hurdle—how to pop her the question! Even normal people find it hard to utter the golden words, so you can imagine the stress a geek faces!

Bernie Peng was one geek who was determined not to go down that way. A financial software programmer, he felt lucky to have a great girlfriend and hoped to spend the rest of his life with her. While he could have taken her for a romantic dinner and dropped down on one knee, he was not very comfortable with the idea. Instead he spent one month hacking Bejeweled, an arcade game that was his lady's favourite. The game was so programmed that when she reached a certain score a ring would appear on the screen, along with a marriage proposal. When Tammy Li ultimately attained that score, she saw the prize and happily accepted the proposal.

This story has another happy ending. When the makers of the game came to know that it was hacked and used to spell out the marriage proposal, they didn't get mad or consider legal action. Instead the Seattle-based company PopCap, plan to give all the guests at the wedding, a copy of the popular game and also fly the couple down to Seattle for their honeymoon.

PERSONAL AGAIN?

The Server Conspiracy

A virus is a nasty piece of malicious code, which wriggles through smallest of the holes in the big walls. In the past, there have been a couple of instances where codes have even entered manufacturing processes of storage products and infected a batch of them. HP Australia happened to ship its ProLiant servers with optional USB keys, and they happened to contain viruses! Two low-risk worms namely Fakerecy and SillyFDC to be precise.

If the hardware carries a virus even before being used, then where's the guarantee of protection and security against those that originate later!

But why wasn't this found out at the factory itself? HP is giving chance to derive as many cool names that might help them re-brand themselves such as "highly prerogative". Sounds cool, eh?

SEX, SWEETS AND SECRETS

Privacy For Porn

Marketing is one viral disease (or so they say) and can make anyone run for the hills. According to a survey conducted by Infosec, outside Liverpool Street Station, London, women were far more likely to give away their passwords than males. The survey was part of a social engineering exercise for security awareness.

About 45 per cent women shared their password in exchange for chocolate bars with fake market researchers, whereas only 10 per cent of men gave away their login details. Now if you ask for login details and passwords in exchange for something that's tempting, then people tend to melt easily. A poll by Cadbury revealed that 52 per cent of women preferred chocolate over sex.

While nearly 15 per cent males would give up chocolate for sex, (obviously). It's just a password which I can change over the next hour. Many may share this opinion, while a fraud worth a couple of millions could take place using their account details. That's being way too imaginative, yet closer to being a possibility.

It's high time people start using password managers and even Web browsers have password management option. So, the next time some one offers free chocolate or sex / porn, don't get tempted.

OOPS

Dot Causes Blood Feud

Turkish couple Ramazan (24) and Emine (20) Çalçoban were having quite a disturbed marriage and had mutually separated. However, the "love" still remains—they continue to exchange strings of text messages over their phones.

Yet another fight ended with a message that Ramazan sent to Emine which was intend to mean "You change the topic every time you run out of arguments." Apparently, Ramazan's cell phone didn't support the Turkish closed "i" (an "i" with no dot). The word "sikisinca" (see? even our font doesn't support it) appeared as "sikisince", which made it severely offensive.

Enraged by this message to Emine, her father and her two sisters attacked him with knives. In the ensuing kerfuffle, Ramazan wound up with a knife in his chest, which he managed to extract and share with Emine. Ramazan managed to escape, but Emine bled in the ambulance, while waiting for traffic to clear.

Ramazan was soon nabbed by the cops, and still baffled by the proceedings, killed himself, confused for eternity.

This flaw in localisation has apparently been the cause of many misunderstandings, but none as deadly. Sadly enough, this causes problems with "delicate" words more than anything, so the result will likely never be funny. It's about time someone yelled bloody murder about these localisation problems.

Take A Crack, And zOther zStories

There are times when we receive letters of adulation that brings tears to our eyes. This month, however, we were all reduced to the type of tears that the human body secretes when opening the mouth way too wide to laugh your guts out!

A reader, who shall remain un-named, took our "Take a Crack" section a little too literally, and sent us a mail that said:

*"Hello Digit, I want to **take a crack** of Adobe Photoshop. Pls send fast."!*

In other news, Fatbeing (Nimish) decided to bunk a day of work. He was also shameless enough to tell Raaabo (Robert) that he's bunking because he didn't "feel like coming in to work". Usually, we reward honesty here at *Digit*, but shamelessness is another thing altogether. Here's a chat transcript of what transpired:

Raaabo: *zdude, zi zgot za zvirus zthat zadds za zz zbefore zevery zword zi ztype.*
Fatbeing: *riiiight!*
Raaabo: *zno zseriously, zand zi zcan't zeven zsearch zgoogle zfor za zsolution zbecause zit's zlike ztyping z"zvirus" zin zgoogle*
Fatbeing: *lol. really? You serious?*
Raaabo: *zdo zi zsound zlike zi zam zkidding zaround zhere? zi zthink zit's zadding za zz zafter zevery zspace. zcheck zgoogle zfor zme zplease*
Fatbeing: *Alrighty then. hang on.*
One hour later...
Raaabo: *zfound zanything?*
Fatbeing: *Nope, been looking for ages, can't find anything.*
Raaabo: *LOL! April Fool!*
Fatbeing: *You $*&#@%$!*

Blog Watch

Twitter stops twitting, and robots plan doom!

MG Siegler
http://tinyurl.com/5m6g69
http://www.parislemon.com/2008/04/if-twitter-breaks-in-woods-and-no-one.html
If Twitter breaks in the woods.....
I noticed a few people thinking the same thing as me today: is everyone taking a break from Twitter? People do get burnt out from the web after all..... But no, Twitter is broken. People are updating and most of the updates are simply not coming through.

Click on some of your friends' profiles. You'll see they have updates, yet those updates are probably not in your Twitter stream. But some are, making things even more confusing, and making it harder for people to tell that Twitter is broken...

Darren Rowse
http://tinyurl.com/6q4gee
http://www.problogger.net/archives/2008/04/26/blog-design-does-it-matter/
Blog Design—Does it Matter?
How important is the design of your blog and how hard a decision do you think it would be to develop a new theme for it? There will probably be a little debate over this one in the comments on this post because every time I see someone write about design there are two opposing arguments.

On the one side are some bloggers who argue that design is secondary and not that important, and that it's content that is what draws people to a blog and keeps them there...

Evan Ackerman
http://tinyurl.com/6l9q99
http://www.botjunkie.com/2008/04/25/robot-laser-deathmatch-is-just-practice-for-world-takeover/
Robot Laser Deathmatch Is Just Practice For World Takeover
These little laser-equipped robots may not scare you that much, but this is how it all starts: right now, they're a foot tall, but give them a couple generations and they'll be crushing us under their giant metal feet. In the meantime, though, we get to watch these KHR-1HV humaniod remote controlled robots take part in a 4 v 4 game of laser tag.

Gameplay seems to be a lot like a conventional game of retail laser tag: run around and shoot anything that moves on the way to the enemy base, where you mindlessly pound away at the sensor 'cause it's worth the most points. In this case, hitting another robot causes it to fall over and become incapacitated for five seconds and the team loses a point. Games last five minutes, and the winners (I assume) get to strip the losers for spare parts.

■ Confirmed: Google does own gooooooooooooooooooooooooooooooooooooogle.com ■ Western Australia decrees laser pointers "weapons"

■ Japanese telecom major to provide cell phone users "fragrance download" service ■ Google and Yahoo work to dumb down the smartphone